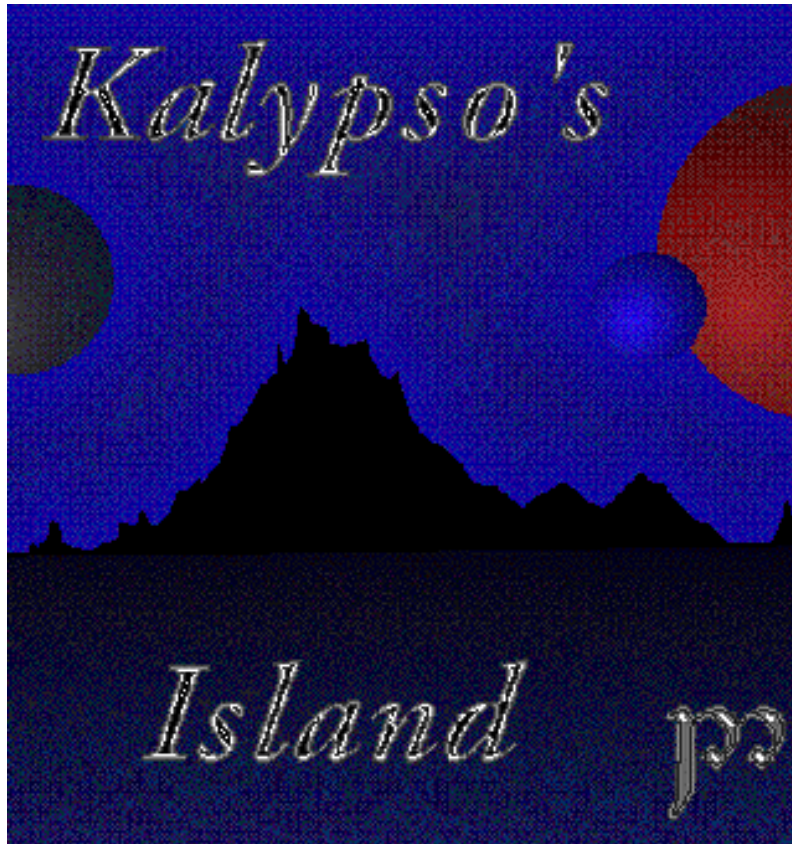


Kalypso's Island

Version 1.0.x · by Dusty L. Johnson · 1998

Part I of the Princess Aria Collection

(Edited by Samuel J. Wood in 2026)



A month before the ship set sail, you met one another... several powerful adepts of various skills and races destined to positions of high honor in the court of Bywater. Your families have worked hard, sacrificed, and paid all the right people off for years to see to this opportunity, and as you step onto the ship which will take you within a day's mountainous walk of the great city itself you find a slight uneasiness creeping over you.

Setting your fears aside, you kiss your relations goodbye (except for the orcs who give one another a black eye in parting) and walk up the gang plank and set forth towards your futures. For three days the weather and winds are favorable, driving the sturdy ship far from the coasts of home. Then, a horrible storm blows up from the east, driving the ship and her crew desperately before its fierceness. Spells and enchantments are thrown at the winds, trying to calm them, but nothing seems to work.

Then, the great mast cracks! The sailors fight to cut it free before it takes the ship down with it, but a blast of lightening slays them. The lot of you leap up into their places and try to free the ship before it flounders, but with another sudden lurch the entire ship breaks apart on rocks. The mast sheers off, but instead of trying to be rid of it, your little group clings to it desperately, fighting for survival.

In the hours that follow you hear the voices of the sailors choke off or fade away knowing that soon you may be following them to a very miserable death. Cold and half drowned, you can hardly believe it when, with the coming of morning, the storm abates.

No sign of the rocks or the ship or any other land breaks the bleak ocean before you, but at least your basic supplies survived along with a little food and the few bits of gold you had in your pockets.

After several days, the mast drifts within sight of land and you begin to paddle your way towards it. As you draw closer you see that it is an island but the whole shore seems surrounded in rocks and crags. Bit by bit you see that it is huge, filling the horizon, but you also see the waves crashing against the rocks and in a few minutes you are fighting with the mast trying to survive the assault. After hours you are nearly exhausted, the mast is broken, but you lie on a small sandy isle just a short way from the mainland. You have survived!

But now, where are you?

In the beginning of this scenario, you have no more motivation than to survive. You are totally free to wander about, check out what you will, and in general get lost. Don't worry, the island isn't all that big. You must be warned, however, that not everything in this game will just lay down and die simply because you are a big-bad-adventuring-person. It is a good bet in fact that should you go into a dragon filled cavern with low level characters you will die. Save often. Don't give up. Die often. Whimper. Don't give up. There are a few hidden little encounters in this game. In case you're not sure how to handle this, just press the little encounter button and try something. My favorite is DETECT MAGIC. Here, there, anywhere you care to just poke about. It works wonders. Also, there are a few points that you must pass over a few times for them to do anything. Some points do something, but if you go over them enough something new and wonderful happens. Okay, mainly this is in the case of people. Just don't rush around too much. The game will still be there in the morning.

I have added a new race and a new class to this scenario, mainly to test out my ability to do so. The Dji race are the mixing of mortal blood with the Djinni race. Hey, if you put a batchelor guy with a demure and nearly omnipotent blond for enough time, one of them is going to think of things to do which might produce off-spring. The added class, the Trickster, is the ultimate in clown/gambler/thief but with some very harsh restrictions. Have fun and try them out.

There are also a number of new items to play with, but in Divine Right, nothing new lasts forever. More specifically, new items do not carry over into other scenarios. Once you're done in this scenario, sell them, ditch them, burn them. Sorry, but that's the law of the Realmz.

Now, sit back, flex your wrist to loosen that carpal tunnel wrist up, and settle in to enjoy Kalypso's Island.

Caspia

Leaving the wreck behind, a massive mage points towards the West. Going that way is actually pretty good advice since the one major city of the island lies just beyond the mountain passes. If you take the northern pass, you'll meet a few of the local entrepreneurs who wish to apply their trade with you. The other pass does not have such an active greeting party. In fact, it's rather dull.

Once you get to the city, however, real life begins.

The city is far from a perfect place to live, but the crime inside the walls has been kept to a minimum. Public executions are at three every day.

The Nobility

You've come to Caspia and Kalypso's Island ignorant of their customs and laws. You're also a bit behind on the local hub-bub and hullabaloo. The good King who ruled for forty-eight years has died in his sleep just weeks before you came. Actually, he died the same day that the storm arose which sank your ship. Once more, the prince was crowned the day your ship was destroyed.

Coincidence.

To be considered a noble, you basically must have the charge of peace and prosperity for a region. Kingship is the right to these by bloodline. Men are Kings, women are... not. Although a woman can be a noble, but she has no right to a throne. Yes, men

created that law.

Now, the Prince, King, has a lover named Lady Lianna. She is the leader of the southern city of Arn. Unlike the King, she got her title by leading a troop of six fighters and two archers against a horde of eighty-two goblins and saved the city. The old leader ran from the battle and thus the people named her their new protector. Lady Lianna has taken that charge to heart, built up relations with the dwarves, and improved the city a great deal.

The King also has a younger brother, but he's not much to talk about.

Eventually you're going to hear about some prophecy involving the King. Pay attention to this because it is true. A great deal of what goes on in the game will pass right over your head if you don't pay attention. I'd really hate for that to happen. Also, keep an eye on the lord chamberlain. I don't trust him.

Dragons

Everyone knows dragons as the scourge of the world of goodness. Good dragons are rare and hunted by those who would have war with the humanoid races. The species as a whole loves the taste of human flesh. They will fight to the death and are nearly impossible to defeat. They have mighty spells, deadly fangs and claws, and never forget that breath. Facing a dragon on its own ground is almost certain death.

With that said, I am pleased to announce that there are dragons aplenty on Kalypso's Island. The best part of it all is that some deep plot is astir involving them... a plot which will change the entire face of the island. You will be powerless to stop this plot, but you may hinder it a little by finding and killing the greatest of the evil dragons on the island, Bathur. One bit of helpful information I can provide is that no dragon can tolerate dragon's bane and live. In the cave of the dragons, just south of Caspia, you may find dragon's bane and be able to stick close to it to avoid being hunted and eaten by a hoard of dragons. It looks like cave mushrooms, smells bad, and does not settle in the stomach well.

Quick Cheats

Okay, so you're looking for all the good stuff without actually gaming. You're not interested in actually playing the game... you want everything there is and you want it now! Well my friend, look no further... 'cause I ain't gonna tell you!

I really hate giving away the end of the story before people have even read the first

chapter. There are very few things hidden in this game that are really hard to find, so all I'm willing to give you are clues.

The Great Templar

There is a temple in the city of Caspia which is wonderful. It is so wonderful that only people of great wisdom and intelligence are allowed inside, and the path is guarded by nearly impossible riddles. Hey, those riddles took me hours to come up with (okay, one of them is an oldie.) Anyway, you must answer five riddles in order to get through.

Riddle #1 : Pay attention to each letter of what is being said.

Riddle #2 : It's a four letter word which is not bright.

Riddle #3 : More of the type of number 1.

Riddle #4 : Gods enjoy imMORTALITY.

Riddle #5 : Think this one out on your own. Just sit there in front of your computer and stare at your hands on the keyboard. Something will come to you eventually. Try twiddling your thumbs.

Shop of Wonders

This shop is extremely restricted, and only by speaking the proper password and answering a riddle can you gain access. All I will say is this, the correct answer is in the library and will send shivers through you.

The Seer's Cult

In the lands far to the east of Caspia, there is a cavern where the followers of an insane seer hide from the King. To go see the seer, you must accept the help and companionship of a small boy.

Lost Dwarven City

Within the great mountain is an area where you can find the lost dwarves. You probably need to dig somewhere to find them... then you need to swim somewhere to escape.

Ruins of Durn

In the southern lands is the ruined city of Durn. You cannot get into the castle in this scenario because you're not strong enough. You can, however, get the old King's sword. Just wait around. You do want that sword.

Treasury

There is a lot to be gained by playing Kalypso's Island. Aside from the standard treasures which add to you general wealth, a great number of +1 and +2 weapons, and a general mass of nice goodies from the stores, look hard for the following:

- Cloak of Enchanters
- The One Staff
- The King's Claw
- Bow of Shalomar
- Sea Heart (Dagger)
- Devout Holy Symbol
- and many more...

Tourist Traps

There are two shrines in the scenario which allow you to buy a blessing of either more stamina or more magic. These do not come cheap by any means, and the shrines are well out of the way and quite hidden, but also well worth the journey. Just be sure you have a good amount of gems (gems and not gold) to pay with.

Well, I guess that's it for this little manual. Enjoy the scenario!

